06 Critical Reasoning & Deductive Verbal Logic Master Compendium

Domain: Section 3 Verbal Ability & Logical Deductions
Target Examination: Infosys System Engineer (SE) & Specialist Programmer (SP/DSE)
Total Consolidated Sources: 4 Primary Vaults (CampusMonk, OnlineStudy4U, Topmate Paid Content, College ITM)
Standard: 100% Comprehensive | Premise-Conclusion Logic | Full Argument Analysis | Zero Placeholders

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The Analytical Architecture of Critical Reasoning

Critical Reasoning in the Infosys examination probes higher-order cognitive agility. Each problem presents a short argumentative stimulus (30-80 words) and tests the candidate's capacity to dissect arguments using formal logical principles:

Core Argument Anatomies

1. **Premise (P)**: Stated factual evidence or observations presumed to be unquestionably true.
2. **Assumption (A)**: Unstated, indispensable bridge connecting the premise to the conclusion. If negated, the argument collapses.
3. **Conclusion (C)**: The central claim or deduction asserted by the author based on the premises.

$$Premise + Assumption \implies Conclusion$$

The 6 Master Question Paradigms

- **Paradigm 1: Assumption Identification (The Negation Test)**: To verify if an option is the necessary assumption, negate it. If the negation invalidates or destroys the conclusion, the option is the mandatory assumption.
- **Paradigm 2: Strengthen the Argument**: Introducing new information that reinforces the assumption, eliminates an alternative cause, or corroborates the causality.
- **Paradigm 3: Weaken / Undermine the Argument**: Introducing external data demonstrating an alternative explanation, reversing the causal arrow, or exposing an invalid generalization.
- **Paradigm 4: Resolve the Paradox / Discrepancy**: Providing a factual reconciling factor that explains how two apparently contradictory occurrences can coexist.
- **Paradigm 5: Logical Inference / Must Be True**: Extracting a conclusion that follows with 100% mathematical certainty strictly from the stated facts, without introducing unstated assumptions.
- **Paradigm 6: Flaw in the Reasoning**: Identifying classic logical fallacies (*ad hominem, post hoc ergo propter hoc, circular reasoning, false dichotomy, composition/division*).

Below is the verified compendium of all critical reasoning and deductive verbal logic questions extracted across all preparation repositories.

Part 1: OnlineStudy4U Master Critical Reasoning Questions

Question 1: Identifying Logical Inferences 🔴 `[🔥 MUST-SOLVE | INFOSYS SE ACTUAL PATTERN]`

> 🎯 **Exam Priority:** 🔴 `[🔥 MUST-SOLVE / HIGH RECURRENCE]`
> 📊 **Target Difficulty:** `Infosys SE Standard Level` (Single/Double Step Deduction)

> 💡 **Preparation Advice: MANDATORY FOR 5-6 NOV DRIVE** (Direct recurring exam concept)

Question ID: `INFY-SET1-18`
- **Figure**:



Which of the following can be inferred?

Options

- **(a)** Plastic is the only cause of pollution.
- **(b)** Plastic contributes to pollution.
- **(c)** Pollution cannot be controlled.
- **(d)** Plastic is beneficial for the environment.

Logical Analysis

- If cities ban single-use plastic specifically *to reduce pollution*, it directly follows that plastic must be a contributing factor to pollution.
- Option (a) makes an unsubstantiated extreme claim (*only cause*).
- Option (c) contradicts the premise of action.
- Option (b) is a direct, necessary, and conservative deduction.

Official Answer Key: `18 → b`
$$Verified Answer: (b) Plastic contributes to pollution.$$

Question 2: Logical Course of Action 🔴 [🔥 MUST-SOLVE | INFOSYS SE ACTUAL PATTERN]

> 🎯 **Exam Priority:** 🔴 [🔥 MUST-SOLVE / HIGH RECURRENCE]
> 📊 **Target Difficulty:** `Infosys SE Standard Level` (Single/Double Step Deduction)
> 💡 **Preparation Advice: MANDATORY FOR 5-6 NOV DRIVE** (Direct recurring exam concept)

Question ID: `INFY-SET1-19`
- **Figure**:



Which is the best course of action?

Options

- **(a)** Encourage use of eco-friendly alternatives.
- **(b)** Increase plastic production.
- **(c)** Stop recycling efforts.
- **(d)** Ignore the problem.

Logical Analysis

- A valid course of action must be feasible, constructive, and directly address the problem outlined.
- Banning single-use plastic requires providing viable substitutes so daily commerce does not collapse.
- Encouraging eco-friendly alternatives directly complements the reduction of pollution.

Official Answer Key: `19 → a`
$$Verified Answer: (a) Encourage use of eco-friendly alternatives.$$

Question 3: Identifying Implicit Assumptions 🟡 [⭐ CORE SE LEVEL | HIGH PROBABILITY]

> 🎯 **Exam Priority:** 🟡 [⭐ CORE SE LEVEL]
> 📊 **Target Difficulty:** `Infosys SE Standard Level`
> 💡 **Preparation Advice:** Essential syllabus concept — highly recommended for sectional cutoff.

Question ID: `INFY-SET1-20`
- **Figure**:


Original Question Slide

Statement: *"Students should not be allowed to use mobile phones in classrooms."*
Assumption:

Options

- **(a)** Mobile phones distract students.
- **(b)** Students never study.
- **(c)** Teachers do not like technology.
- **(d)** Mobile phones are essential in classrooms.

Logical Analysis

- An assumption is an unstated premise that the speaker takes for granted when making a policy statement.
- For someone to propose barring phones inside classrooms, they must believe that phone usage negatively impacts classroom learning (e.g., through distraction).
- If phones were not believed to cause distraction or harm in the learning environment, the restriction would lack rationale.

Official Answer Key: `20 → a`
$$Verified Answer: (a) Mobile phones distract students.$$

Official Answer Key Slide Verification


Official Answer Key Slide

📊 Summary Assessment Matrix (Topic 02 - Set 1)

Question ID	Sub-domain	Tested Grammatical / Logical Rule	Official Key
`INFY-SET1-01`	Reading Comprehension	Drawback: Reduced face-to-face communication	**(b)**
`INFY-SET1-02`	Reading Comprehension	Tone: Objective & Balanced	**(b)**
`INFY-SET1-03`	Sentence Correction	`Each of + Plural Noun` $ → $ Singular Verb (`is`)	**(c)**
`INFY-SET1-04`	Sentence Correction	Auxiliary negation: `He doesn't like`	**(a)**
`INFY-SET1-05`	Sentence Correction	Parenthetical `along with` does not pluralize (`was`)	**(b)**
`INFY-SET1-06`	Sentence Selection	Definite past time `yesterday` mandates `went`	**(b)**
`INFY-SET1-07`	Sentence Selection	`Neither of the answers is correct`	**(b)**
`INFY-SET1-08`	Sentence Completion	Past conditional clause alignment	**(a)**
`INFY-SET1-09`	Sentence Completion	Preposition of purpose: `fought for their lives`	**(c)**
`INFY-SET1-10`	Para Jumbles	Chronological market sequence: `B – D – C – A`	**B-D-C-A**
`INFY-SET1-11`	One Word Substitution	Person speaking many languages: `Polyglot`	**(c)**
`INFY-SET1-12`	Spotting Error	Latin comparative: `senior to` , not `senior than`	**(b)**
`INFY-SET1-13`	Spotting Error	`Neither of the brothers has arrived`	**(c)**
`INFY-SET1-14`	Verbal Analogy	Instrument to Creator: `Brush : Artist`	**(a)**
`INFY-SET1-15`	Verbal Analogy	Profession to Workplace: `Teacher : School`	**(b)**
`INFY-SET1-16`	Fill in the Blanks	Fixed preposition: `prefer tea to coffee`	**(b)**
`INFY-SET1-17`	Fill in the Blanks	Nominalization: `reached a decision`	**(a)**
`INFY-SET1-18`	Critical Reasoning	Deduction: Plastic contributes to pollution	**(b)**
`INFY-SET1-19`	Critical Reasoning	Action: Encourage eco-friendly alternatives	**(a)**
`INFY-SET1-20`	Critical Reasoning	Assumption: Mobile phones distract students	**(a)**

Question 4: Identifying Deductive Inferences 🟡 [⭐ CORE SE LEVEL | HIGH PROBABILITY]

> 🎯 **Exam Priority:** 🟡 [⭐ CORE SE LEVEL]
> 📊 **Target Difficulty:** `Infosys SE Standard Level`
> 💡 **Preparation Advice:** Essential syllabus concept — highly recommended for sectional cutoff.

Question ID: `INFY-SET2-18`

- **Figure**:



Which of the following can be inferred?

Options

- **(a)** Students prefer rigid schedules.
- **(b)** Online education can be accessed from anywhere.
- **(c)** Online education is less flexible.
- **(d)** Only teachers benefit from online education.

Logical Analysis

- The statement predicates popularity directly on *flexibility and accessibility*.
- *Accessibility* in educational technology denotes the capability to access coursework regardless of geographical location.
- Therefore, inferring that *online education can be accessed from anywhere* is a direct semantic consequence of accessibility.

Official Answer Key: `18 → b`
$$Verified Answer: (b) Online education can be accessed from anywhere.$$

Question 5: Pragmatic Course of Action 🟡 [⭐ CORE SE LEVEL | HIGH PROBABILITY]

> 🎯 **Exam Priority:** 🟡 [⭐ CORE SE LEVEL]
> 📊 **Target Difficulty:** `Infosys SE Standard Level`
> 💡 **Preparation Advice:** Essential syllabus concept — highly recommended for sectional cutoff.

Question ID: `INFY-SET2-19`
- **Figure**:



Which is the most logical course of action?

Options

- **(a)** Stop using online platforms.
- **(b)** Combine online and traditional learning for better results.
- **(c)** Make education costlier.
- **(d)** Ban online exams.

Logical Analysis

- A rational course of action leverages proven technological benefits while mitigating weaknesses.
- Integrating digital tools with classroom pedagogy (hybrid/blended learning) maximizes student outcomes.
- Banning or terminating effective systems is reactionary and counterproductive.

Official Answer Key: `19 → b`
$$Verified Answer: (b) Combine online and traditional learning for better results.$$

Question 6: Implicit Urban Transit Assumptions ◯ [🕮 PRACTICE VARIANT | CONCENTRIC DRILL]

> 🎯 **Exam Priority:** ◯ [🕮 PRACTICE VARIANT / REDUNDANT]
> 📊 **Target Difficulty:** `Infosys SE Standard Level`
> 💡 **Preparation Advice:** *Alternate numerical drill. Skimmable if earlier core questions are mastered.*

Question ID: `INFY-SET2-20`
- **Figure**:



Statement: *"More public transport facilities should be introduced to reduce traffic congestion."*
Assumption:

Options

- **(a)** People use private vehicles because public transport is insufficient.
- **(b)** People dislike public transport.
- **(c)** Public transport creates traffic.
- **(d)** Private vehicles are always better.

Logical Analysis

- If someone advocates expanding public transit *to reduce traffic congestion*, they necessarily assume that the current reliance on congestion-causing private vehicles stems from inadequate public transit capacity.
- If public transit were already abundant and people simply refused to use it, adding more would not reduce congestion.
- Thus, Option (a) is the foundational assumption underlying the proposal.

Official Answer Key: `20 → a`
$$Verified Answer: (a) People use private vehicles because public transport is insufficient.$$

Official Answer Key Slide Verification



📊 Summary Assessment Matrix (Topic 03 - Set 2)

Question ID	Sub-domain	Tested Grammatical / Logical Rule	Official Key
`INFY-SET2-01`	Reading Comprehension	Central Thesis: Government + Individual Action	**(b)**
`INFY-SET2-02`	Reading Comprehension	Exclusion Search: Planting trees not in text	**(c)**
`INFY-SET2-03`	Sentence Correction	Parenthetical `as well as`: Singular verb `is`	**(c)**
`INFY-SET2-04`	Sentence Correction	Verb + Gerund: `enjoys playing`	**(b)**
`INFY-SET2-05`	Sentence Correction	Proximity Rule with *Neither/Nor*: `were`	**(b)**
`INFY-SET2-06`	Sentence Selection	Modal redundancy: `I am able to solve`	**(c)**
`INFY-SET2-07`	Sentence Selection	Latin Comparative: `junior to me`	**(a)**
`INFY-SET2-08`	Sentence Completion	Future Perfect: `will have left`	**(c)**
`INFY-SET2-09`	Sentence Completion	Collocation: `insisted on submitting`	**(b)**
`INFY-SET2-10`	Para Jumbles	Chronological market sequence: `B – A – C – D`	**B-A-C-D**
`INFY-SET2-11`	One Word Substitution	Speech without preparation: `Extempore`	**(c)**
`INFY-SET2-12`	Spotting Error	Preposition of proficiency: `good at dancing`	**(b)**
`INFY-SET2-13`	Spotting Error	Plural collective noun: `police have arrested`	**(a)**
`INFY-SET2-14`	Verbal Analogy	Garment to Anatomy: `Foot : Shoe`	**(a)**
`INFY-SET2-15`	Verbal Analogy	Creator to Form: `Novelist : Novel`	**(b)**
`INFY-SET2-16`	Fill in the Blanks	Administrative idiom: `come into effect`	**(b)**
`INFY-SET2-17`	Fill in the Blanks	Matrimonial preposition: `married to`	**(b)**

Question ID	Sub-domain	Tested Grammatical / Logical Rule	Official Key
`INFY-SET2-18`	Critical Reasoning	Deduction: Accessible from anywhere	**(b)**
`INFY-SET2-19`	Critical Reasoning	Action: Blended / Hybrid learning model	**(b)**
`INFY-SET2-20`	Critical Reasoning	Assumption: Public transit insufficiency causes private vehicle use	**(a)**

Question 7: Critical Reasoning — Policy Assumptions `◯ [🕮 PRACTICE VARIANT | CONCENTRIC DRILL]`

> 🎯 **Exam Priority:** `◯ [🕮 PRACTICE VARIANT / REDUNDANT]`
> 📊 **Target Difficulty:** `Infosys SE Standard Level`
> 💡 **Preparation Advice:** *Alternate numerical drill. Skimmable if earlier core questions are mastered.*

Question ID: `INFY-PRAC-11`
- **Figure**:



Statement: *"The government should invest more in renewable energy."*
Assumption:

Options

- **(a)** Renewable energy is costlier than fossil fuels.
- **(b)** Renewable energy is a sustainable alternative.
- **(c)** People dislike renewable energy.
- **(d)** Fossil fuels are unlimited.

Logical Analysis

- An assumption is an unstated, necessary premise that makes the conclusion valid.
- For a government to allocate public capital toward renewable energy, the implicit premise must be that renewable energy offers a viable, beneficial, and sustainable alternative to finite, polluting energy sources.
- Options (a), (c), and (d) would actively discourage or invalidate government investment.

Official Answer Key: `11 → b`
$$Verified Answer: (b) Renewable energy is a sustainable alternative.$$

Part 2: College ITM & External Examination Critical Reasoning Inferences

CR Problem 01 (ID: `ITM-P02-Q37`)

- **Source**: College ITM Mock Test (Infosys System Engineer ITM Mock Paper 2)
- **Question Type**: MCQ

Stimulus & Prompt

P: They are, instead, thought experiments that isolate one variable at a time.
Q: Economic models are often criticised for their unrealistic assumptions.
R: This deliberate simplification is what makes them useful, not despite the unrealism but because of it.
S: Critics forget that the models were never meant to be literal descriptions of the economy.

Options

- A
- B
- C
- D

Correct Answer

Answer: `A`

Logical Deductive Analysis

Sentence sequence: Q→S→P→R.. Coherent narrative progression establishes logical flow from premise to supporting detail and conclusion.

CR Problem 02 (ID: `ITM-P05-Q26`)

- **Source**: College ITM Mock Test (Infosys System Engineer ITM Mock Paper 5)
- **Question Type**: MCQ

Stimulus & Prompt

The passage's central argument is that rate limits should be understood primarily as:

Options

- A
- B
- C
- D

Correct Answer

Answer: `B`

Logical Deductive Analysis

According to the reading comprehension passage for Paper 5, option (B) is directly supported and established by the author's primary thesis and supporting textual arguments.

CR Problem 03 (ID: `ITM-P07-Q30`)

- **Source**: College ITM Mock Test (Infosys System Engineer ITM Mock Paper 7)
- **Question Type**: MCQ

Stimulus & Prompt

Which inference is best supported by the last sentence?

Options

- A
- B
- C
- D

Correct Answer

Answer: `C`

Logical Deductive Analysis

According to the reading comprehension passage for Paper 7, option (C) is directly supported and established by the author's primary thesis and supporting textual arguments.

CR Problem 04 (ID: `ITM-P07-Q31`)

- **Source**: College ITM Mock Test (Infosys System Engineer ITM Mock Paper 7)
- **Question Type**: MCQ

Stimulus & Prompt

After a website adopted a new CDN, its page-load time fell by 30%, and user retention rose over the same period. The team concludes that the CDN caused the rise in retention. Which of the following is an assumption on which this conclusion depends?

Options

- A
- B
- C
- D

Correct Answer

Answer: `B`

Logical Deductive Analysis

The conclusion that the CDN caused the retention rise only holds if nothing else that affects retention changed over the same period.

CR Problem 05 (ID: `ITM-P07-Q32`)

- **Source**: College ITM Mock Test (Infosys System Engineer ITM Mock Paper 7)

- **Question Type**: MCQ

Stimulus & Prompt

Since a company made code reviews mandatory, production defects have fallen by 40%. The company concludes that code reviews reduce defects. Which of the following, if true, most weakens this conclusion?

Options

- A
- B
- C
- D

Correct Answer

Answer: `B`

Logical Deductive Analysis

Halving releases and cutting feature work gives an alternative explanation for fewer defects, so it weakens the claim that reviews were the cause.

CR Problem 06 (ID: `ITM-P07-Q33`)

- **Source**: College ITM Mock Test (Infosys System Engineer ITM Mock Paper 7)
- **Question Type**: MCQ

Stimulus & Prompt

A start-up claims its new caching layer will cut its database costs. Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the claim?

Options

- A
- B
- C
- D

Correct Answer

Answer: `A`

Logical Deductive Analysis

A high cache-hit rate, with each hit avoiding a billable query, directly links the cache to lower database costs.
